Level 5 Adult ESL Curriculum: Scope and Sequence

Status: Published (October 28, 2026). Lesson pages, slide decks, and listening audio for Lessons 1–13 are on the site.

Date: October 25, 2026

Audience: Program coordinators and volunteer teachers

Sits directly above: the Level 4 curriculum (level4/curriculum/Level4_Scope_and_Sequence.md, 13 lessons, Week 8 midterm, Week 15 final, Week 16 graduation). **Sits at the top of this series.** There is no Level 6 in this plan.

> **Topics:** taking part at work, at home, and in the community: a job interview, a project that changed, wishes and regrets, rules with *unless* and *as long as*, a bill or a statement, passing on what someone said, confirming details, a call to a school office, judging a website, a compromise at work, a claim or a complaint letter, a meeting, and a short talk.

How this document is organized

Section	What's inside
1. Rationale and research basis	Who Level 5 is for, and the frameworks it is based on
2. Entry and exit skills	What learners can do at the start and at the end
3. Handoff from Level 4	What Level 5 assumes, what it adds, and what changed from the five-level outline
4. Course design	The weekly routine, group sizes, language support, grammar format, materials, assessment and progress checks
5. Semester at a glance	One table for all 16 weeks, and where every grammar strand is taught
6. Week by week	Every lesson: theme, can-do goals, grammar Q&A, words, listening, Read & Write, Talk Time, exit ticket
7. Midterm, final, and graduation	What each one covers and how it works
8. Decisions	The choices this plan uses for the lesson build

1. Rationale and Research Basis

1.1 Why a Level 5, and who it is for

Level 4 graduates can talk about experiences (*Have you ever…? How long have you…?*), imagine a situation (*If I had…, I would…*), give an opinion and disagree politely, and write a short email. What they usually cannot do yet is talk about an action that is **still going on** (*How long have you been working here?*), put **two past times in order** (*By the time the inspector arrived, we had already painted*), say what they **wish** had happened, **report** another person's words, ask a **polite indirect question** (*Do you know if…?*), **confirm** a detail (*You sent it, didn't you?*), and **judge** whether something they read is reliable. Those are the skills adults need for an interview, a bill, a phone message, a school office, a meeting, and a short talk. Level 5 teaches them.

Target learner: an adult who finished Level 4 (or places at that level) and can hold a conversation, give a reason, and write a short paragraph with some help. About 95% speak Spanish; the rest speak a range of other languages. Most read and write in their first language. Some are repeating learners who want more speaking and writing practice.

1.2 Level estimates (our estimate, not an official alignment)

Framework	Level 4 (existing)	Level 5 (this course)
NRS Educational Functioning Levels for ESL (U.S. Department of Education, adult education reporting)	Low Intermediate → **High Intermediate ESL**	Starts at **High Intermediate ESL**; aims to finish at **Advanced ESL**
CEFR (Council of Europe; "plus" levels from the 2020 *Companion Volume*)	A2+ → B1	**B1 → B1+** (moving toward B2)
CASAS	Same life-skill content areas (see 1.3). CASAS tests can report learners on the NRS levels. We **do not** claim any score alignment	Same

What these levels describe, in plain words (paraphrased):

- **NRS High Intermediate ESL:** the learner understands short new phrases on familiar topics, can take part in limited conversations, and has inconsistent control of more complex grammar.
- **NRS Advanced ESL:** the learner understands longer speech on familiar topics, can take part in conversations and group talk, and can read and write connected paragraphs, still with some errors.
- **CEFR B1:** the learner understands the main points of clear speech on familiar matters, deals with most everyday situations, connects sentences, and gives short reasons.
- **CEFR B1+:** the stronger half of B1: the learner keeps a conversation going, explains a point of view, and writes a simple connected text.

The Level 5 exit goal is NRS Advanced ESL and CEFR B1+, applied to work, family, health messages, money papers, school, and community situations. The can-do lists in Section 2 are written to match.

Note on test scores: CASAS publishes score ranges for each NRS level, and the ranges differ by test series and year. Newer NRS descriptors are aligned with the federal English Language Proficiency Standards for adult education. If the program needs scores for reporting, use the current official tables, not this document.

1.3 Content areas (CASAS-style life skills)

Content area	Level 5 lessons
Basic communication (interviews, wishes, confirming, a short talk)	1, 3, 7, 13
Consumer economics (a statement, a budget, a claim)	5, 11
Community resources (a school office, a library meeting)	8, 12
Health (passing on a clinic message; no diagnosis)	6
Employment (interviews, a project, rules, a compromise)	1, 2, 4, 10
Independent living (notices, bills, a complaint letter)	4, 5, 11
Learning and civic skills (judging a source, leading a meeting, a talk)	9, 12, 13, and every week

1.4 Teaching principles (and where they come from)

Principle	What it means in Level 5	Basis
A short summary, not one sentence	Every Talk Time answer is about four connected sentences, or a spoken summary of about 30 seconds. The exit ticket is a short written or spoken summary.	CEFR B1+ descriptors for explaining a viewpoint and writing a simple connected text
Grammar through real tasks	Each grammar point is tied to one real job: present perfect continuous → an interview; past perfect → a project timeline; *wish* → a missed deadline; passive → a statement; reported speech → a phone message; tag questions → checking a form.	Task-based language teaching (for example, Rod Ellis, *Task-Based Language Learning and Teaching*, 2003)
Explicit, easy-to-explain grammar	Every box has a one-line rule of thumb. Volunteers never need grammar terms beyond the box. The hard pairs (*worked* vs. *been working*, *said* vs. *told*, falling vs. rising tags) get one board picture.	Focus on form within meaning-focused tasks
Pictures with every word	Every vocabulary word has a picture card, as in Levels 1–4.	Dual coding (Allan Paivio)
Many meetings with each word	Each word appears in New Words, the listening, a grammar box or Talk Time, Read & Write, the homework, and a later lesson.	Paul Nation, *Learning Vocabulary in Another Language*
Listen for the main idea, then details	The audio is longer, at natural speed, and it uses the full forms *going to* and *want to*. A text tip still says that people often say *gonna* and *wanna*. The first listen is for gist and the second for details.	Common listening-instruction practice (pre-, while-, and post-listening stages)
Learners lead some of the talk	Lessons 1–9 are teacher-led, with pair and group work. In Lessons 10–13 a learner leads one round (a timekeeper, a chair, or a question-asker).	The five-level outline: longer Talk Time; learners lead

2. Entry and Exit Skills

2.1 Entry (who should start in Level 5)

A learner belongs in Level 5 if, in a short placement chat, they **can** do most of these:

- answer *Have you ever…?* and *How long have you lived here?* (*I've lived here for three years*)
- talk about an imaginary situation (*If I had more time, I would…*)
- disagree politely and give a reason (*I see your point, but…*)

…and **cannot yet** comfortably do most of these:

- answer *How long have you been working here?* with *I've been working…*
- report what someone said (*She told me to call back*)
- ask *Do you know if the office is open?*

Learners who cannot yet do the first list probably belong in Level 4. Learners who can do both lists can still take Level 5; this is the top level of the series.

2.2 Exit (what learners can do at the end)

Talking and listening: learners can…

- prepare for a job interview and talk about an accomplishment with an example
- talk about an action that is still going on (*How long have you been…?*)
- put two past times in order (*By the time…, I had already…*)
- talk about a wish or a regret, including one light third-conditional sentence (*If I had asked, I would have known*)
- explain a condition with *unless* and *as long as*
- say what was done, without saying who did it, when that is how a form or a statement is written (*The payment was received*)
- report what someone said, told, or asked
- ask a polite indirect question (*Do you know if…? / Do you know whether…?*)
- confirm a detail with a tag question (*You sent it, didn't you?*)
- say how sure they are (*It must be… / It might be… / It can't be…*) and name one reason a website is or is not reliable
- suggest a compromise and explain a result with *so… that* or *such… that*
- file a simple claim or write a complaint: what happened, what they want, and a polite close
- take part in a meeting: follow an agenda, ask a question, and say which proposal they support
- give a 2–3 minute talk with an introduction, two examples, and a conclusion

Reading and writing: learners can…

- read texts of 250–400 words (a job posting, a short project update, a notice, a statement plus a note, a phone-message log, a school newsletter, a web page, a meeting agenda, a claim letter) and find the main idea, the writer's purpose, and two details
- write a paragraph of about 6–8 sentences in the first half of the course
- write a 1–2 paragraph email or letter (a complaint, a request, or a thank-you) by the end
- write a talk outline (introduction, examples, conclusion) and speak from it

Grammar they control (in practiced situations): present perfect continuous, and present perfect vs. present perfect continuous for *How long*; past perfect with *when / by the time*; *wish* + past and *wish* + *had* + participle; a light third conditional; *unless*, *as long as*, *even though*; passive (present and past) with an optional *by*; reported speech with *said / told / asked*; embedded questions with *if / whether* and with *wh-*; tag questions for confirmation; gerunds as subjects; *so / such… that*; modals of deduction (*must / might / can't*); relative clauses with *which* and *where*; polite softeners (*I was wondering if…*); a light *should have*.

Reviewed, not re-taught: simple past; past continuous next to the past perfect; present perfect; second conditional; *too / enough*; *must / have to*; *will*; the first conditional; *who / that*; separable phrasal verbs; *Can / Could you…?*

3. Handoff from Level 4

3.1 What Level 4 teaches and Level 5 assumes

Level 5 Lesson 1 opens with a **brief** present-perfect warm-up, then moves to *have been* + *-ing*. Everything below is **not re-taught**. It appears in the 6:00 Opening Talk, in a homework item, or as support for a new point.

Level 5 assumes learners know…	Level 4 teaches it in	Where Level 5 uses it
Present perfect for experiences and *for / since*	Lessons 1–2	Lesson 1 (next to *have been working*); Lesson 13 (the talk)
already / yet / just	Lesson 3	Lesson 2 (*had already*)
Suggestions; a calm health history	Lesson 4	Lesson 6 (a clinic message, not a diagnosis)
Would you mind…?; *Can / Could you…?*	Lesson 5	Lesson 10 (a compromise); Lesson 11 (*I was wondering if…*)
Second conditional	Lesson 6	Lesson 3 (next to *wish* and one third-conditional sentence)
too / enough; *must / mustn't / don't have to*	Lesson 7	Lesson 4 (a notice); Lesson 10 (*The week was too full*)
might / may / could; *Do you know where…?*	Lesson 8	Lesson 8 (*Do you know if…?*); Lesson 9 (*must / might / can't*)
Opinions; *as… as*	Lesson 9	Lesson 10 (a compromise); Lesson 12 (a meeting)
Separable phrasal verbs	Lesson 10	Lesson 10, three review verbs only (*work out, call off, give in*)
Verb + *to* vs. verb + *-ing*; infinitive of purpose	Lesson 11	Lesson 11 (a gerund as the subject: *Waiting on hold is tiring*)
who / that	Lesson 12	Lesson 12 (*which, where*)
before / after / when; a 2-minute talk	Lesson 13	Lesson 2 (*by the time*); Lesson 13 (a 2–3 minute talk)

Level 4's "deliberately not in Level 4" list lands here: present perfect continuous → **Lesson 1**; past perfect → **Lesson 2**; *wish* and a light third conditional → **Lesson 3**; *unless / as long as* → **Lesson 4**; passive → **Lesson 5**; reported speech → **Lesson 6**; tag questions → **Lesson 7**; embedded *if / whether* → **Lesson 8**; modals of deduction → **Lesson 9**; *so / such… that* → **Lesson 10**; gerunds as subjects and polite softeners → **Lesson 11**; *which / where* → **Lesson 12**.

Planned overlap (on purpose): *interview, training, résumé* are new picture words (Level 4 did not teach a job interview). *appointment, clinic, confirm* come back in new jobs (a message, a form, a school call) and are **not** repeated as picture-page words if Level 4 already has that picture. Otherwise, Level 5 vocabulary is chosen not to repeat the Level 1–4 picture pages.

3.2 What this level does not hand off

This is the last level in the series. Skills that stay light on purpose, and why:

Skill	What this plan does	Why
Full third conditional in every person and both clause orders	One pattern in Lesson 3: *If I had asked, I would have known*	Volunteers can explain one pattern. The rest of the paradigm is not needed for the exit can-do.
Every passive (*is being done, has been done, get*)	Present *is / are* + participle and past *was / were* + participle only	Those are the forms on bills, letters, and signs.
Full reported-speech backshift	*say / tell / ask*; present → past; *will* → *would*; *asked me to*; *asked if*	Enough to pass on a real message.
Rising tag questions as a debate tool	Taught as "I think this is true; please confirm," with falling intonation. The rising pattern is mentioned so learners can hear it.	The exit can-do is confirming, not cross-examining.
Labor law, tenant law, insurance law	Learners read a notice, ask a question, and write a polite letter. A teacher note says this is not legal advice.	A volunteer class cannot give legal advice. Local help lines go on the "Keep practicing" sheet.
Credit scores, loans, and debt counseling	Lesson 5 reads a simple statement and a three-line budget. No product is recommended.	The outline asked for budget and credit language, not financial advice.
Background noise in the audio	Not in the first build (Decision 4)	The class speaker and the listening check need clear speech.

3.3 Changes from the five-level outline (moved, merged, or limited)

Every exit can-do, core grammar strand, and life-skill theme in the Level 5 outline (Five_Level_Map.md) is assigned to a lesson (see 5.1). **Nothing was dropped.** These items were moved, merged, or limited, and why:

Outline item	What this plan does	Why
Audio about 2:00–3:00, 2–4 speakers, some background sound, played 1–2 times	Target **about 2:05–2:40**. Up to **3 speakers in one scene**, and a **fourth only in a second scene** in the same file. **Two plays** in class (gist, then detail); a third is allowed. **No background bed** in the first build. The words in the file are *going to* and *want to*.	Same reason as Level 4: one clear job for the volunteer, and a file the checker can hear. Decision 4.
English-only pages; glossary with a *My language* column at the end of the book	Followed. No contrast-tip box. No *My language* column on the weekly New Words page.	The outline's support row. Mix-ups live in the English mistakes table. Decision 1.
should have (strand table, light)	One row inside Lesson 3, next to *I wish I had…*	It is the same idea as a regret. It does not need its own night.
so / such… that (in the outline's grammar list, not in the strand-table rows)	Lesson 10, inside the compromise lesson	People give a result when they explain a compromise.
Gerund as subject (strand table says P under verb + *-ing*)	**Introduced** in Lesson 11. Level 4 already taught verb + *-ing* after another verb.	*Waiting is hard* is a new job for a form they know.

Outline item	What this plan does	Why
Worker and tenant rights; insurance claims	Lesson 4 reads a workplace notice and a building notice. Lesson 11 is a small insurance claim and a complaint letter.	One night for "read the rule," one night for "ask for a status." Not a law course.
Children's school system and meetings	Lesson 8 is a call to a school office. Lesson 12 is a library meeting, with a second card for a school conference.	Not every learner has a child in school. Both situations use the same English.
Health systems and caregiving	Lesson 6: pass on a clinic message to a family member. Invented, mild, no diagnosis.	Reporting speech needs a real message. A second health lesson would crowd the grammar list.
Personal finance (budget, credit)	Lesson 5: read a statement (a charge, a payment, a credit that is money back) and write a three-line budget.	"Credit" here means a line on a statement, not a credit card offer.
Civic participation	Lesson 12: learners lead a short meeting with an agenda.	The outline says learners lead some Talk Time. This is that night.
Media and online information	Lesson 9, with *must / might / can't*	Judging a source needs the deduction modals.
Career advancement and interviews	Lesson 1	The first night is a workshop, not a real interview with the teacher.
Workplace conflict and compromise	Lesson 10, peer to peer (a shared Saturday)	A role-play that accuses a boss is the wrong task for this room.
Personal achievement and community support	Lesson 13	The graduation talk.
Changes over time	Lesson 2 (a shop getting ready to open)	Past perfect needs two past times. A renovation timeline is safer than a life story. Life stories stay in Lesson 13, and they are the learner's choice.

4. Course Design

4.1 Weekly routine

Learners coming from Level 4 will recognize every step. Level 5 changes four things: the listening block is **20 minutes** (the file is longer), **Talk Time is 18 minutes**, **Read & Write is 7 minutes** because the text is longer and the writing is finished at home, and the **exit ticket is a short summary** (about four sentences, or 30 seconds spoken and then written).

Clock time	Step	About	What happens
6:00–6:06	1. **Opening Talk + Homework Check**	6 min	Same partner for both. One question on last week's grammar. The answer is a short summary. Then compare one homework item. The teacher writes 2 corrections on the board.
6:06–6:12	2. **New Words**	6 min	Picture page: point, say, repeat; a quick pair game.
6:12–6:32	3. **Listening + "Hear it, say it"**	20 min	Before you listen → **Play 1:** Task A → press play again → **Play 2:** Tasks B and C → the *gonna / wanna* recognition tip → repeat 2 lines. A third play is OK.
6:32–6:45	4. **Grammar Q&A + pair check**	13 min	The two-sided box, the rule of thumb, questions and answers, common mistakes, then a short pair check.
6:45–7:00	**BREAK**	15 min	
7:00–7:18	5. **Talk Time**	18 min	The main activity, usually two rounds. In Lessons 10–13 a learner leads one round.
7:18–7:25	6. **Read & Write**	7 min	A text of 250–400 words, 4–5 questions, then start the writing. Finish at home.
7:25–7:30	7. **Exit Ticket + Homework**	5 min	**Never skip.** A short summary with today's grammar. Do homework item 1 together.

> **Timing is loose on purpose.** If the listening or Talk Time runs long, take the time from Read & Write. If you are running behind, skip in this order: (1) the Read & Write writing task (it becomes homework); (2) the pair check at the end of Grammar; (3) the second round of Talk Time. **Never skip** the listening tasks, the grammar box and mistakes table, and the exit ticket.

4.2 Group sizes

Classes often start near 15 learners and drop to 7–8. Each lesson's Talk Time in Section 6 lists a **15**, a **7–8**, and a **5 or fewer** version. The other steps work like this every week:

Step	15 learners	7–8 learners	5 or fewer
Opening Talk	Pairs (one group of 3 if odd)	Pairs	Pairs, or one group with the teacher
New Words game	Pairs, then 3 teams	Pairs, then 2 teams	One team against the clock
Listening tasks	Individually, then pairs	Same	The whole group checks together
Grammar pair check	Pairs; swap once if time	Pairs	Pairs; the teacher joins one
Read & Write	Pairs read; individual writing	Same	Read aloud together; individual writing
Exit ticket	Individual, on paper	Same	Same, or spoken first and then written

4.3 Language support

Support	Level 5 plan	Why
Instruction icons	**None**	Same decision as the other levels
Spanish line under each instruction	**None**	Learners know the task words
"My language" on each New Words page	**None**	The outline moves this to the back of the book
Glossary	Optional, at the **back** of the book: English word, a short English note, a blank *My language* column. The learner fills it in.	Useful for the less concrete words (*accomplishment, reliable, compromise*)
Contrast tip	**None.** The common mix-up is a row in the English mistakes table.	English-only student pages, as in the outline
Teacher pages	English only	Teachers need no Spanish

> **Teacher-friendly:** when a learner is stuck, show it (picture, gesture, a timeline), give one more English example, point to the grammar box, let a classmate help for a few seconds, then stay in English.

4.4 Grammar format

Same two-sided boxes as Levels 1–4. Each lesson has a one-line **rule of thumb**, a short "Questions and answers" section, and a "Common mistakes" table (✕ → ✓). Level 5 boxes have up to 6 rows. Lessons 1 and 2 add a **timeline** the teacher draws. Example (Lesson 1):

QUESTION			ANSWER		
How long **have**	you	**been working** here?	I**'ve been working** here	**for**	two years.
How long **have**	you	**worked** here?	I**'ve worked** here	**since**	2024.
Have	you	**finished** the training?	Yes,	I	**have**.
What **did**	you	**do** in your last job?	I **helped** customers	at	a store.

Rule of thumb (Lesson 1): *been* + *-ing* stresses the activity, still going on. *have* + past participle is also correct for *How long*, and it is the form from Level 4. Both answers are accepted. A finished time (*in 2022*) still needs the simple past.

4.5 Materials per lesson

Item	Level 5 detail
Student pages	New Words, Listening, Grammar, Talk Time, Homework, Read & Write, Exit Ticket. No instruction icons. No weekly *My language* column. Same page look as Level 4.
Pictures	12 per lesson (156 total), 600×420 PNG cards made from Twemoji graphics (CC BY 4.0), named L5_L<lesson>_<word>.png. Abstract words get a labeled combination of two emoji or a simple form with one field highlighted. Every picture gets a line in level5/images/CREDITS.md.
Listening audio	One MP3 per lesson, plus a midterm and a final when those are built (15 files). Same pipeline as Level 4: Chatterbox TTS cloned from synthetic reference clips only. **About 2:05–2:40. 2–3 speakers in a scene.** A fourth speaker only if the file has two separate scenes. Natural speed. The spoken lines use *going to* and *want to*. **Female characters use female voices and male characters use male voices.** Each file plays the conversation **once**. The teacher presses play again. **Recorded for Lessons 1–13** (about 1:23–2:17).
Slides	One deck per lesson, built from that lesson's pages with scripts/slides/build_deck.py. Lesson 1 starts from level4/slides/Level4_Lesson13_Slides.pptx. **Not built in this document.**
Teacher plan	At a glance, the clock, step-by-step boxes, the listening script, the answer key, and notes in plain English. **Teachers need no Spanish.**

4.6 Assessment and progress checks

Tool	When	What
Placement chat	Before Week 1	3–4 minutes. The questions in Section 2.1.
Baseline snapshot	Weeks 1–3	The same prompts each time: *How long have you been coming to this class? Tell me about a project you finished. What do you wish you had asked someone? Do you know if the library is open tonight? Tell me one thing a person said to you this week.* About 5 learners a week during Talk Time. The final uses the same prompts.
Can-do self-check	Weeks 1, 8, 15	"I can…" lines and the faces 😀 🙂 😐. The teacher reads each line.
Exit ticket	Every lesson	A short summary with today's grammar. The teacher sorts them into yes / almost / not yet and starts the next class with 2 corrections.
Homework	Every lesson	20–25 minutes: finish the writing, one speaking task, and one older grammar point.
Writing checks	Weeks 2, 5, 7, 11, 14	The teacher writes one strength and one fix. Lesson 2 project note (Week 2), Lesson 5 budget note (Week 5), Lesson 7 confirmation email (Week 7), **Lesson 11 claim letter** (Week 12; the writing is finished at home after Week 12 and collected the next class — the check itself is marked in the calendar at Week 12), Lesson 13 talk outline (Week 14). Learners keep them in a folder.
Midterm / Final	Weeks 8, 15	Listening (played 2 times), grammar, a writing task, and a pair speaking interview. Section 7.

Progress-check calendar: Week 1: placement, self-check, baseline (about 5 learners) · Weeks 2–3: baseline for the rest · Week 2: writing check 1 · Week 5: writing check 2 · Week 7: writing check 3 · Week 8: midterm, self-check, one goal · Week 12: collect the Lesson 11 letter (writing check 4) · Week 14: talk rehearsal, writing check 5 · Week 15: final, self-check.

The Week 12 check is the Lesson 11 letter. There is no separate Week 11 class named "writing check"; Lesson 11 is Week 12 on the semester calendar (Lesson 11 sits in Week 12 because Week 8 is the midterm).

5. The Semester at a Glance

Week	Class	Grammar Q&A focus	Real-life function
1	**Lesson 1 (Week 1):** How Long Have You Been Working Here?	Present perfect continuous; present perfect for *How long*; simple past for a finished job	Talk about work in a practice interview
2	**Lesson 2 (Week 2):** By the Time We Opened	Past perfect with *when / by the time*; *had already*	Tell how a project changed, in order
3	**Lesson 3 (Week 3):** I Wish I Had Asked	*wish* + past; *wish* + *had* + participle; one third-conditional sentence; light *should have*	Talk about a mild regret and what you would do next time
4	**Lesson 4 (Week 4):** Unless You Call First	*unless*; *as long as*; *even though*; review *have to / must*	Read a notice and explain the condition
5	**Lesson 5 (Week 5):** It Was Posted on Tuesday	Present and past passive; optional *by*	Read a statement and say what was done
6	**Lesson 6 (Week 6):** She Told Me to Call	*said / told / asked*; *asked if*; *will → would*	Pass on a clinic message
7	**Lesson 7 (Week 7):** You Sent It, Didn't You?	Tag questions for confirmation	Check the details on a form
8	**Week 8: Midterm**	Review of Lessons 1–7	Review stations + exam
9	**Lesson 8 (Week 9):** Do You Know If It's Tonight?	Embedded *if / whether*; review *Do you know when / where…?*	Call a school office and ask a polite question
10	**Lesson 9 (Week 10):** It Must Be an Ad	*must be / might be / can't be*; what makes a page reliable	Judge a website or a post
11	**Lesson 10 (Week 11):** Can We Meet in the Middle?	Compromise phrases; *so / such… that*; three phrasal verbs	Solve a schedule problem with a coworker
12	**Lesson 11 (Week 12):** I'd Like to File a Claim	Gerund as subject; *I was wondering if…*; review passive	Ask about a claim and write a short letter
13	**Lesson 12 (Week 13):** The Room Where We Meet	*which* and *where*; review *who / that*	Take part in a meeting, and lead one round
14	**Lesson 13 (Week 14):** A Short Talk	Talk frame: introduction, examples, conclusion; review of the semester	Give a 2–3 minute talk
15	**Week 15: Final Exam**	Review of all lessons (focus on 8–13)	Review stations + exam
16	**Week 16: Graduation**	—	2–3 minute talks; certificates

Grammar in teaching order: 1. present perfect continuous (L1) → 2. past perfect (L2) → 3. *wish* and a light third conditional (L3) → 4. *unless / as long as* (L4) → 5. passive (L5) → 6. reported speech (L6) → 7. tag questions (L7) → **midterm** → 8. embedded *if / whether* (L8) → 9. deduction modals (L9) → 10. *so / such… that* and compromise language (L10) → 11. gerund subjects and softeners (L11) → 12. *which / where* (L12) → 13. the talk frame (L13) → **final**.

5.1 Where every core grammar strand is taught

I = introduced (taught in a grammar box) · **P** = practiced / extended · **R** = reviewed (brief).

Strand (from the Level 5 outline and strand table)	Lesson(s)
Present perfect continuous	**I (1)**, P (13)
Present perfect (*How long*, experiences)	**P (1)**, R (2, 13)
Past perfect with *when / by the time*	**I (2)**, R (13)
Past continuous next to the past perfect	**R (2)**
Simple past	**R (1, 2, 3)**
wish + past / *wish* + past perfect	**I (3)**
Third conditional (light)	**I (3)**
should have (light)	**P (3)**
Second conditional	**P (3)**, R (10)
unless; *as long as*; *even though*	**I (4)**
First conditional	**R (4)**
have to / must	**R (4, 11)**
Passive, present and past	**I (5)**, P (11)
too / enough	**R (5, 10)**
Reported speech (*said / told / asked*)	**I (6)**, P (8)
will	**R (6, 13)**
Tag questions	**I (7)**
Embedded *if / whether* and embedded *wh-*	**I (8)**, P (11)
might; deduction *must be / can't be*	**I (9)**; *might* is **P** from Level 4
so / such… that	**I (10)**
Phrasal verbs (review: *work out, call off, give in*)	**P (10)**
Can / Could you…?; polite softeners	**P (10, 11)**
Gerund as subject	**I (11)**
Verb + *-ing* vs. infinitive	**R (11)**
which; *where*; *who / that*	**I (12)** for *which / where*; **R** for *who / that*
Giving a reason; opinions	**P (10, 12)**
Organized talk (introduction, examples, conclusion)	**I (13)** as a speaking frame, not a new verb tense

Spiral: every Opening Talk reuses last week's question. The present perfect continuous comes back when learners answer *How long have you been…?* in later interviews and in the talk. *said / told* comes back when Lesson 8 reports what the office said. The passive comes back in the claim letter (*The photo was attached*).

6. Week by Week

Vocabulary: ★ = most important words. Each word gets a picture card. Talk Time is 7:00–7:18. The teacher plays the audio twice: Task A on the first play, Tasks B and C on the second. Voices: F = female, M = male. All names, companies, prices, phone numbers, and addresses are invented.

Lesson 1 (Week 1): How Long Have You Been Working Here?

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	A practice job interview at a community center: how long you have been doing something, one accomplishment, and a short example. Includes orientation, the first can-do self-check, and the baseline snapshot.
Can-do goals	I can answer *How long have you been…?* • I can also answer with *I've worked… for / since*. • I can give one example of an accomplishment. • I can ask a follow-up question.
Grammar Q&A focus	**R (3 min):** *How long have you lived here?* • **I:** *How long have you been working at the hotel? → I've been working there for two years.* • *She's been taking this class since September.* • **P:** *I've worked there for two years* is also correct. • **R:** simple past for a finished job: *I worked at a bakery in 2022.* • **Rule of thumb:** see the box in 4.4. Both *been working* and *worked* are accepted for a job you still have. A finished year needs the simple past.
Vocabulary (12)	★ résumé • ★ interview • ★ accomplishment • ★ example • ★ skill • ★ job offer • ★ training • ★ portfolio • ★ handshake • ★ follow-up • qualification • name tag
Talk Time	**Round 1, Practice Interview:** A is the interviewer with 6 question cards; B answers in about four sentences (how long, one accomplishment, one example, one reason). Switch. **Round 2, Kind Feedback:** the partner names one clear sentence and asks one follow-up. **15:** pairs, then one rotation. **7–8:** pairs, teacher listens to each pair for the baseline. **5 or fewer:** one table; each person interviews the person on their left.
Listening	**Situation:** a community center holds a practice interview night. Nora interviews for a hotel front-desk job. The coach asks how long she has been working with customers. **Speakers:** Nora, the learner (F); Samir, the coach (M); Ms. Hale, the volunteer interviewer (F). **Length:** 1:37. **Tasks:** A: what job is the practice for? B: complete the notes (how long, one accomplishment, one example); C: write *been working* or *worked*.
Read & Write	**Read:** a one-page job posting and a short "how we interview" note (about 280 words; invented hotel). **Write:** a 6–8 sentence email to the coach: the job you want to practice, how long you have been doing related work, and one accomplishment with an example. Invented details are fine.
Exit ticket	*How long have you been studying English (or doing your job)?* About four sentences: how long, what you have been doing, one example, and why it matters.
Pronunciation	Weak *been* /bɪn/ in *I've been working*. Stress on the job word, not on *been*.
Common mix-up	*I am working here since 2024 → I've been working here since 2024* or *I've worked here since 2024. I've been working here in 2022 → I worked here in 2022*.
Teacher tip	This is practice. Do not ask why someone left a job, what they earn, or how they came to this country. Learners may invent the hotel and the dates. Model a 30-second answer first.

Lesson 2 (Week 2): By the Time We Opened

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Tell the story of a small project in order: a neighborhood bakery getting ready to open. Say what was already done before the next thing happened.
Can-do goals	I can say what had already happened. • I can use *by the time* and *when* with two past times. • I can put four events in order. • I can write a short project note.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** *By the time the inspector arrived, we had already painted the walls.* • *When the oven was delivered, Ben had already cleaned the kitchen.* • *Had you finished the sign before the poster went up? → Yes, we had. / No, we hadn't.* • **R:** past continuous for the later moment's background: *The painter was still working when the inspector knocked.* • **R:** *already* from Level 4, now before *had*. • **Rule of thumb:** the earlier past uses *had* + past participle. The later past uses the simple past. *By the time* marks the later time.
Vocabulary (12)	★ bakery • ★ oven • ★ permit • ★ inspector • ★ paint roller • ★ store sign • ★ ribbon • ★ opening day • ★ counter • ★ display case • awning • poster
Talk Time	**Round 1, Two Timelines:** each learner gets four picture cards from a bakery opening. They were shuffled. The partner asks *What had they already done by the time…?* and they rebuild the order. **Round 2, Tell the Other Group:** a new partner retells the story in four sentences. **15:** pairs, then a second pair. **7–8:** pairs, then one switch. **5 or fewer:** one group builds one timeline on the table.
Listening	**Situation:** Priya and Ben work at a new bakery. The inspector visits before opening day. They tell her what they had already finished. **Speakers:** Priya (F); Ben (M); Ms. Cole, the inspector (F). **Length:** 1:39. **Tasks:** A: is the bakery open yet? B: order five events; C: write *had* or the simple past.
Read & Write	**Read:** a one-page project update from the bakery owner to the staff (about 300 words). **Write:** a 6–8 sentence note about a project you finished (a class, a move inside the city, a team at work). Use *by the time* once and *had already* once. Invented details are fine. (Writing check 1.)
Exit ticket	*Tell one change, in order.* Four sentences with *by the time* or *had already*, plus a reason the order mattered.
Pronunciation	*had* vs. *have* (*we'd already* is easy to miss). In this lesson, say the full *had* so the two times stay clear.
Common mix-up	*When the inspector arrived, we already painted → we had already painted. By the time we had opened, the inspector arrived* swaps the times. The *by the time* half is the later event.
Teacher tip	Draw two X's on a line. Label the left one "earlier: had painted" and the right one "later: the inspector arrived." Projects can be invented. Do not ask learners to describe a move between countries.

Lesson 3 (Week 3): I Wish I Had Asked

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Mild regrets about class, work, or a sign-up deadline: what you wish were true now, what you wish you had done, and one sentence about a different past.
Can-do goals	I can say *I wish I had…* for a past regret. • I can say *I wish I knew…* for something I want now. • I can say one *If I had…, I would have…* sentence. • I can say what I will do next time.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** *I wish I knew the answer* (want it now; past verb). • *I wish I had asked the teacher* (past regret; *had* + participle). • **I (light):** *If I had asked, I would have known.* • **P:** *I should have asked earlier.* One row, same meaning as the wish. • **P:** second conditional for next time: *If I had another chance, I would ask on the first day.* • **Rule of thumb:** *wish* about now → past verb (*knew, had, were*). *wish* about the past → *had* + participle. After *If I had* + participle, the other half is *would have* + participle.
Vocabulary (12)	★ wish • ★ regret • ★ calendar • ★ reminder • ★ alarm • ★ sign-up sheet • ★ tutor • ★ practice • ★ question • ★ choice • help desk • next time
Talk Time	**Round 1, Wish Cards:** groups get six mild cards (*I missed the sign-up. I didn't ask for the example. I arrived after the explanation.*). Each person says *I wish I had…* and *Next time I will….* **Round 2, One Different Past:** each person adds *If I had…, I would have…* and the group repeats the clearest one. **15:** 5 groups of 3. **7–8:** 2 groups. **5 or fewer:** one group; the teacher adds a card.
Listening	**Situation:** after class, Alicia and Chris talk about a workshop they signed up for late. They wish they had asked sooner. The conversation stays light, and they decide what to do next time. **Speakers:** Alicia (F); Chris (M). **Length:** 1:23. **Tasks:** A: what do they regret? B: match person → wish → next step; C: write *wish I had* or *would have*.
Read & Write	**Read:** a short advice note from a tutor, about 260 words, answering "I missed the sign-up." **Write:** a 6-sentence note to yourself: one wish about now, one wish about the past, one *If I had* sentence, and what you will do next time.
Exit ticket	*Write about one mild regret.* Four sentences: the wish, the *if* sentence, what you should have done, and the next step.
Pronunciation	*I'd* can mean *I had* or *I would*. In *I wish I'd asked*, it is *I had*. In *I'd ask next time*, it is *I would*. Say the full words the first time.
Common mix-up	*I wish I would have asked → I wish I had asked. If I would have asked → If I had asked. I wish I know → I wish I knew.*
Teacher tip	Cards stay on class, work schedules, and sign-ups. No cards about family loss, money trouble, or leaving a country. Any next step with a reason is a good answer. Do not grade the feeling.

Lesson 4 (Week 4): Unless You Call First

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Read a workplace visitor notice and a short building notice. Explain the condition: *unless*, *as long as*, and *even though*.
Can-do goals	I can explain *unless* in my own words. • I can say what is allowed *as long as* something else is true. • I can contrast with *even though*. • I can ask one polite question about a rule I do not understand.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** *You can't go in unless you sign the book.* (= if you do not sign) • *You can bring a guest as long as you tell the front desk.* • *Even though the office is busy, you still need an appointment.* • **R:** *You have to sign in. You must wear the visitor badge.* • **R:** first conditional: *If you call first, they will hold the room.* • **Rule of thumb:** *unless* means *if… not*. *As long as* means "only if this stays true." *Even though* means the result happens anyway.
Vocabulary (12)	★ policy • ★ notice • ★ appointment • ★ cancel • ★ confirm • ★ visitor • ★ front desk • ★ office hours • ★ requirement • ★ permission • exception • visitor badge
Talk Time	**Round 1, Notice Sort:** pairs get six rule strips and match each one to *unless*, *as long as*, or *even though*. **Round 2, Ask the Desk:** A is the front desk; B asks one question about a rule (*What happens unless I call?*). Switch. **15:** pairs, then a new partner. **7–8:** pairs. **5 or fewer:** the whole group sorts the strips, then pairs ask.
Listening	**Situation:** Andre arrives for a meeting and did not call first. Helen at the front desk explains the rule. A coworker, Mei, tells him he can wait as long as the 4:00 group finishes on time. **Speakers:** Andre (M); Helen (F); Mei (F). **Length:** 1:48. **Tasks:** A: can he go in now? B: true / false on the rules; C: write *unless*, *as long as*, or *even though*.
Read & Write	**Read:** a one-page workplace visitor policy and a six-line building notice (about 320 words together; invented). **Write:** a 6-sentence note to a coworker explaining two rules, with *unless* and *as long as*.
Exit ticket	*Explain one rule from tonight.* Four sentences: the rule, *unless* or *as long as*, an example, and who to ask if you are not sure.
Pronunciation	*unless* stressed on the second syllable. *as long as* said as one chunk.
Common mix-up	*Unless you will call → Unless you call*. *As long as you will tell them → As long as you tell them*. Same present-verb rule as *if* for the future.
Teacher tip	These notices are invented. Say: "This lesson is not legal advice. For a real question about your job or your building, ask that office, or use the local help line on the Keep practicing sheet." Do not role-play evictions, firings, or punishments.

Lesson 5 (Week 5): It Was Posted on Tuesday

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Read a simple phone and internet statement: what was charged, what was paid, and what was credited (money back). Write a three-line budget (money in, bills, left over). No product is sold or recommended.
Can-do goals	I can say what is done with *is / are* and *was / were* + a participle. • I can add *by* when the doer matters. • I can find the amount due, the due date, and one charge on a statement. • I can write a three-line budget with invented numbers.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** *The bill is mailed on the first of the month.* • *The fee was added on Tuesday. The payment was received on Friday.* • *The credit was posted by the phone company.* (*by* = who did it; use it only when you need the name.) • *Are the calls listed? → Yes, they are. / Was the fee removed? → No, it wasn't.* • **R:** *too much* from Level 4, one line: *The fee is too high.* • **Rule of thumb:** when the paper cares about the thing, not the person, start with the thing: *The payment was received.* The verb is a form of *be* + the past participle.
Vocabulary (12)	★ statement • ★ charge • ★ payment • ★ balance • ★ fee • ★ receipt • ★ refund • ★ budget • ★ deposit • ★ due date • account number • credit (money back)
Talk Time	**Round 1, Statement Gap:** A has the statement; B has questions (*What was charged? When was the payment received?*). B fills a blank form. Switch with a second statement. **Round 2, Three Lines:** pairs write an invented budget: money in, two bills, what is left. They read it with two passive sentences (*The rent was paid. The fee was not included.*). **15:** pairs, then one new statement. **7–8:** pairs. **5 or fewer:** one statement on the board.
Listening	**Situation:** Diego calls customer service about a statement. Ms. Brooks explains which fee was added and which payment was already posted. Nothing is due today. The tone is calm. **Speakers:** Diego (M); Ms. Brooks (F). **Length:** 1:43. **Tasks:** A: why is he calling? B: complete the amounts and dates; C: write the passive verb (*was added / was received*).
Read & Write	**Read:** an invented one-page statement and a 120-word note on how to read it (about 300 words of text plus the table). **Write:** a 6-sentence note to a family member about the statement, plus a three-line budget with invented numbers. (Writing check 2.)
Exit ticket	*Explain one line from a statement.* Four sentences, two of them passive, and one reason you would call the company.
Pronunciation	Past participles: *posted* /ɪd/, *charged* /d/, *asked* /t/. The *was* is quiet; the participle carries the meaning.
Common mix-up	*The fee was add → was added. The company was posted the payment → The payment was posted* or *The company posted the payment.*
Teacher tip	Never ask what learners earn, owe, or spend. All amounts are on the cards. "Credit" on this page means money back on a statement. Do not recommend a loan, a card, or a bank. If a charge looks wrong in real life, say: "Call the number on your own statement."

Lesson 6 (Week 6): She Told Me to Call

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Pass on a short clinic message: the time changed, what the nurse said, and what she asked. Invented and mild. No symptoms are diagnosed.
Can-do goals	I can report a statement with *said* and *told*. • I can report a request with *asked me to*. • I can report a yes/no question with *asked if*. • I can write the message so another person can act on it.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** *The nurse said, "The checkup is on Thursday." → She said (that) the checkup was on Thursday.* • *She told me (that) the time had changed. Tell* needs a person. *Say* does not. • *She asked me to call before 3:00.* • *She asked if Thursday was OK.* • **R:** *will → would*: *"We will call you." → She said they would call me.* • **Rule of thumb:** *told me*, not *told to me* and not *said me*. For a request, *asked me to* + verb. For a yes/no question, *asked if* + statement order.
Vocabulary (12)	★ message • ★ note • ★ callback • ★ nurse • ★ clinic • ★ folder • ★ detail • ★ time change • ★ family member • ★ relay • phone log • waiting room
Talk Time	**Round 1, Message Relay:** A reads a direct-speech card quietly. B tells C: *She said… / She told me to… / She asked if….* C writes the message and reads it back. Rotate. **Round 2, Is It Enough?:** the group checks the written message: who, what day, what to do. **15:** groups of 3, then a new card. **7–8:** two groups of 3–4. **5 or fewer:** one relay around the table.
Listening	**Situation:** Jana calls the clinic. The nurse moves a checkup to Thursday and asks her to bring the appointment card. Jana then tells her brother Ken, at home, exactly what was said. **Speakers:** Jana (F); Nurse Patel (F); Ken (M). The nurse scene ends before the home scene starts. **Length:** 1:41. **Tasks:** A: did the checkup stay on the same day? B: complete the message (day, time, what to bring); C: write *said*, *told*, or *asked*.
Read & Write	**Read:** a phone-message log and a short "how to pass on a message" box (about 280 words). **Write:** the message Jana would leave for a family member who missed the call (6–8 sentences).
Exit ticket	*Report one thing someone said in class tonight.* Four sentences with *said* or *told*, *asked me to* or *asked if*, and why the detail matters. The quote can be from the lesson, not from a classmate's private life.
Pronunciation	*said* /sɛd/ (not "sayed"). Weak *that* when you include it. *told me* linked.
Common mix-up	*She said me → She told me* or *She said. She told that → She said that* or *She told me that. She asked me if I can come → if I could come*, when the asking is in the past.
Teacher tip	All clinics and times are invented. Do not ask about real symptoms, medicines, or family health. Say: "For a real health question, ask your clinic. In an emergency, call 911." Caregiving here means passing on a message, not giving care instructions.

Lesson 7 (Week 7): You Sent It, Didn't You?

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Confirm the details on a class registration or a delivery time: spelling, email, day, and phone number. The tag means "I think this is right. Please confirm."
Can-do goals	I can add a tag to a statement I think is true. • I can answer a tag with a short yes or no. • I can correct a wrong detail politely. • I can write a confirmation email.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** *You sent the form, didn't you? → Yes, I did.* • *The class is on Tuesday, isn't it?* • *She isn't on the list, is she? → No, she isn't. / Actually, she is.* • Positive statement, negative tag. Negative statement, positive tag. • The falling tone means you are checking, not starting an argument. • **Rule of thumb:** the tag uses the same helping verb as the statement, and it flips the yes/no. If there is no helping verb, use *do / does / did*.
Vocabulary (12)	★ spelling • ★ email address • ★ phone number • ★ schedule • ★ signature • ★ form • ★ checkbox • ★ correction • ★ double-check • ★ copy • initial • capital letter
Talk Time	**Round 1, Detail Check:** A has a form with four details; B has a slightly different copy. They confirm with tags and correct one item: *It's Tuesday, isn't it? Actually, it's Wednesday.* **Round 2, Read-Back:** B sends a two-sentence confirmation. A listens and answers the tag. **15:** pairs, swap forms once. **7–8:** pairs. **5 or fewer:** one form, and the teacher reads a wrong detail.
Listening	**Situation:** Leah confirms her evening-class registration with Mr. Ortiz at a community center desk. One detail is wrong (the room). She corrects it. **Speakers:** Leah (F); Mr. Ortiz (M). **Length:** 1:30. **Tasks:** A: is every detail correct at the start? B: mark correct or wrong for five details; C: write the tag (*didn't you / isn't it / is she*).
Read & Write	**Read:** a filled registration form and a 200-word email that confirms it, with one deliberate mismatch (about 320 words including the form labels). **Write:** a confirmation email of 6–8 sentences that names the mismatch and the correction. (Writing check 3.)
Exit ticket	*Confirm two details about this class.* Four sentences, two of them tags, and one correction or one *Yes, it is.*
Pronunciation	Falling intonation on the tag when you are sure and only checking. Mention that a rising tag can mean a real question. This lesson practices the falling check.
Common mix-up	*You sent it, didn't you? → Yes, I didn't* (if the answer is yes, the short answer stays positive: *Yes, I did*). *You sent it, did you?* when you mean the falling check. The check on a positive sentence takes *didn't*.
Teacher tip	Do not collect real Social Security numbers, immigration papers, bank numbers, or medical record numbers. The forms use a class ID, an email, and an invented phone number. Praise the correction, not the speed.

Week 8: Midterm (Review Stations + Exam)

See Section 7. Covers Lessons 1–7. No new content.

Lesson 8 (Week 9): Do You Know If It's Tonight?

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Call a school office or a community program office. Ask *Do you know if…?* and *Do you know whether…?* Report what the office said. Learners may be parents, caregivers, or volunteers. The cards do not assume everyone has a child.
Can-do goals	I can ask *Do you know if / whether…?* • I can keep statement order after *if*. • I can ask *Do you know when / where…?* the Level 4 way. • I can report the answer with *said* or *told*.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** *Do you know if the conference is tonight? → Yes. It starts at 6:30. / I'm not sure.* • *Do you know whether I need a permission slip?* • *Can you tell me if the office is still open?* • **P:** *Do you know where the office is?* / *Do you know when it starts?* (statement order, from Level 4). • **P:** report it: *He said the conference was tonight. He told me to bring the slip.* • **Rule of thumb:** after *Do you know if / whether / when / where*, use statement order. Not *Do you know if is the conference tonight?*
Vocabulary (12)	★ school office • ★ counselor • ★ conference • ★ permission slip • ★ dismissal • ★ pickup • ★ newsletter • ★ backpack • ★ sign-up • ★ office window • bell • hallway
Talk Time	**Round 1, Office Call (back to back):** A is the caller with a goal card (conference time, early pickup, a permission slip). B is the office, with an information card. A must use *Do you know if* at least twice. **Round 2, Pass It On:** A tells a new partner what the office said. **15:** pairs, then a new partner for round 2. **7–8:** pairs. **5 or fewer:** one call the whole group can hear, then each person asks one more question.
Listening	**Situation:** Maya calls Northside School's office. She volunteers with an after-school reading hour. She asks whether the conference is tonight and if she should bring the signup sheet. Mr. Reed answers and asks her to arrive ten minutes early. **Speakers:** Maya (F); Mr. Reed (M). **Length:** 1:43. **Tasks:** A: why is she calling? B: complete the notes (day, time, what to bring); C: write *if*, *whether*, or *where*.
Read & Write	**Read:** a school newsletter page about conference week (about 340 words; invented school). **Write:** a 6–8 sentence email to the office that asks two indirect questions and confirms one detail.
Exit ticket	*Write the question you would ask the office, and the answer you hope for.* Four sentences: two with *Do you know if / whether*, one reported answer, and a reason.
Pronunciation	*Do you know if* as one friendly chunk, rising a little at the end because it is a real question. Statement order stays even when the voice rises.
Common mix-up	*Do you know if is the office open? → Do you know if the office is open? Do you know where is the conference? → where the conference is?*
Teacher tip	Say at the start: "Some cards are a parent. Some are a volunteer. Pick either one." Do not ask who has children. The school is invented. No grades, no discipline stories, and no immigration paperwork.

Lesson 9 (Week 10): It Must Be an Ad

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Decide whether a short web page is reliable: who wrote it, how old it is, and whether it is an advertisement. Say *must be*, *might be*, and *can't be* with a reason.
Can-do goals	I can say how sure I am with *must*, *might*, and *can't*. • I can name two clues (author, date, ad, a mismatch). • I can say what I would do before I believed the page. • I can tell a classmate, with a reason.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** *It must be an ad. It has a "Buy now" button.* (you are almost sure) • *It might be old. The date says 2019.* • *It can't be the city's page. The logo is different.* • **P:** *might* for a guess you are less sure about (Level 4). *must* and *can't* are stronger. • **Rule of thumb:** *must / might / can't + be* or another base verb. *Can't* here means "that is not possible," not "is not able."
Vocabulary (12)	★ website • ★ source • ★ author • ★ advertisement • ★ screenshot • ★ fact • ★ rumor • ★ date stamp • ★ logo • ★ comment • reliable • share button
Talk Time	**Round 1, Three Pages:** groups get three invented screenshots (a city bus notice, a "amazing deal" page with no author, a neighborhood post with no date). They label each *must be / might be / can't be* and give a reason. **Round 2, Before You Share:** each person says what they would check before they forwarded the page. **15:** 5 groups of 3. **7–8:** 2 groups. **5 or fewer:** one group, all three pages.
Listening	**Situation:** Noah shows Aisha a post that says their grocery store is closing. They look for the author and the date. Aisha thinks it must be a rumor. Noah finds the store's own page, which says the store is open. **Speakers:** Noah (M); Aisha (F). **Length:** 1:50. **Tasks:** A: is the store closing? B: list the clues they use; C: write *must*, *might*, or *can't*.
Read & Write	**Read:** two short pages about the same library event (about 360 words together). One is the library's page. One is a repost with a wrong time. **Write:** a 6–8 sentence message to a friend: which page you trust, two clues, and what the person should do.
Exit ticket	*How can you tell that a page might be wrong?* Four sentences with *must*, *might*, or *can't*, and one reason.
Pronunciation	Stress the modal: *It MUST be an ad. It CAN'T be official. Might* stays softer.
Common mix-up	*It must an ad → It must be an ad. It can be not the city page → It can't be the city page. Must to be → must be.*
Teacher tip	Use only the invented pages in the lesson. If a learner brings up a real post, say: "Let's stay with our class pages." No elections, no health cures, no crime stories. "Reliable" means you can name the author and the date, and the page matches a second source. It does not mean "I like it."

Lesson 10 (Week 11): Can We Meet in the Middle?

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Two coworkers share a Saturday job. They disagree, then meet in the middle. A learner keeps the time in round 2.
Can-do goals	I can say what I need and ask what the other person needs. • I can offer a middle idea. • I can explain a result with *so… that* or *such… that*. • I can use *work out*, *call off*, or *give in* in a real sentence.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I (phrases):** *What if we split the day? Let's meet in the middle. I can take the morning if you take the afternoon.* • **I:** *The week was so busy that we split Saturday.* • *It was such a long shift that we shared it.* • *so* + adjective; *such* + *a / an* + adjective + noun. • **P:** *work it out, call it off, give in*. Noun in the middle or after; *it* only in the middle (*work it out*), the Level 4 rule, reviewed not re-taught. • **R:** *too* (*The week is too full for one person*). • **Rule of thumb:** say the other person's idea in one sentence before you offer yours. *So* and *such* both mean the result was big enough to cause the next clause.
Vocabulary (12)	★ compromise • ★ offer • ★ counteroffer • ★ priority • ★ shared task • ★ solution • ★ fairness • ★ sticky note • ★ break time • ★ swap • whiteboard • middle
Talk Time	**Round 1, Saturday Split:** pairs get different constraint cards (morning class, a family visit, a second job). They must leave with a written compromise. **Round 2, Learner Timekeeper:** groups of 3. One learner keeps a 4-minute timer, makes sure both people speak, and reads the compromise aloud. Rotate the leader. **15:** pairs, then groups of 3. **7–8:** pairs, then one group of 3 and pairs. **5 or fewer:** one group; rotate the timekeeper.
Listening	**Situation:** Camila and Jon both think they need Saturday off. Their lead, Ms. Nguyen, asks them to work it out before she calls the shift off. They split the day. **Speakers:** Camila (F); Jon (M); Ms. Nguyen (F). **Length:** 2:11. **Tasks:** A: what is the problem? B: write each person's limit and the compromise; C: write *so* or *such*.
Read & Write	**Read:** a half-page team note about shared weekend duties (about 300 words). **Write:** a 6–8 sentence message to a coworker proposing a compromise, with one *so… that* or *such… that*.
Exit ticket	*Describe a small compromise.* Four sentences: what each person needed, the middle idea, a *so / such* result, and why it was fair.
Pronunciation	Friendly stress on the offer: *What if WE split it?* Falling tone on *Let's meet in the middle*, so it sounds like a suggestion.
Common mix-up	*The week was so busy so we split it → so busy that we split it. It was so long shift → such a long shift. Give in the argument* is the wrong pattern; *give in* has no object here.
Teacher tip	The conflict is a schedule between coworkers, not a complaint against a boss and not a pay dispute. Ms. Nguyen only asks them to decide. Do not role-play yelling. Praise the sentence that repeats the other person's need.

Lesson 11 (Week 12): I'd Like to File a Claim

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Ask about a small insurance claim (a cracked phone screen, or a water stain that is already dry) and write a two-paragraph letter: what happened, what you want, and a polite close.
Can-do goals	I can start a sentence with a gerund (*Waiting on hold is tiring*). • I can soften a request with *I was wondering if….* • I can say what was sent or attached, in the passive. • I can write a 1–2 paragraph letter.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** *Waiting on hold is tiring. Filing a claim takes time. Sending a photo helps.* The *-ing* word is the subject. • **P:** *I was wondering if you could check the claim.* • *Would you mind looking up the reference number?* (Level 4). • **P:** *The photo was attached. The form was received.* • **R:** *You have to include the policy number.* • **Rule of thumb:** a gerund subject is one activity, treated as it. The verb after it is singular: *Waiting is*, not *Waiting are*.
Vocabulary (12)	★ claim form • ★ policy number • ★ photo • ★ estimate • ★ complaint • ★ attachment • ★ reference number • ★ customer service • ★ on hold • ★ resolution • cracked screen • water stain
Talk Time	**Round 1, The Call:** A is the customer with a claim card. B is customer service with a status card (*received, missing the photo, in review*). A must use *I was wondering if* and one gerund subject. Switch. **Round 2, Letter Outline:** pairs list the two paragraphs (what happened; what you are asking) before anyone writes full sentences. **15:** pairs, then switch roles with a new card. **7–8:** pairs. **5 or fewer:** one call the group coaches, then individual outlines.
Listening	**Situation:** Hector calls about a cracked-screen claim. Ms. Lane says the form was received and asks him to send the estimate. He stays polite. The phone call is the whole file. **Speakers:** Hector (M); Ms. Lane (F). **Length:** 2:02. **Tasks:** A: what is the claim about? B: complete the status and what he still must send; C: write the gerund or *was received / was attached*.
Read & Write	**Read:** a claim-status letter from an invented insurer (about 380 words). **Write:** a two-paragraph reply (about 8–12 sentences): paragraph 1, what happened and what was sent; paragraph 2, what you are asking, with *I was wondering if* and a thank-you. (Writing check 4, collected the following week.)
Exit ticket	*Start a claim letter.* Four sentences: a gerund subject, one passive, the request, and a polite close.
Pronunciation	*I was wondering if* as one soft chunk. The gerund keeps its *-ing*: *filing*, *waiting*, *sending*.
Common mix-up	*Waiting on hold are tiring → is tiring. I was wondering if could you check → if you could check* (statement order). *The photo was attach → was attached*.
Teacher tip	The damage is a phone screen or a dry stain. Nobody is hurt, and the home is safe. Do not invent a fire, a flood, or an injury. Say: "This letter is practice. It is not insurance advice. For a real claim, use the phone number on your own policy." Do not ask if learners have filed a claim.

Lesson 12 (Week 13): The Room Where We Meet

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	A library meeting about evening hours. Learners follow an agenda, refer to a proposal, and one learner chairs a four-minute round. A second card set uses the same English for a school conference.
Can-do goals	I can point to a thing with *which* and a place with *where*. • I can still use *who* for a person. • I can ask a question from the agenda. • I can give my opinion with a reason and listen to one other opinion.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I:** *The proposal which the chair read is on page 2.* • *This is the room where we meet.* • *The person who takes notes is the secretary.* • **R:** *who / that* from Level 4. *Which* is for things. *Where* is for places. • **P:** opinion phrases from Level 4: *I think… / I see your point, but…* • **Rule of thumb:** *which* and *who* tell you which thing or person. Do not add *it* or *he* after them (*the proposal which the chair read*, not *which the chair read it*). *Where* replaces *there*.
Vocabulary (12)	★ agenda • ★ chairperson • ★ minutes • ★ microphone • ★ handout • ★ proposal • ★ sign-in sheet • ★ name tent • ★ timer • ★ question card • library • auditorium
Talk Time	**Round 1, Read the Agenda:** groups of 4 get a one-page agenda (welcome, the proposal, questions, a decision). Each person prepares one question with *which* or *where*. **Round 2, A Learner Chairs:** the chair keeps the order, invites one speaker, and stops at four minutes. The group writes one sentence: the decision and one reason. A second set of cards is a school conference for groups that prefer it. **15:** 4 groups (one of 3). **7–8:** 2 groups. **5 or fewer:** one meeting; rotate the chair if you have time.
Listening	**Situation:** a short library meeting. Ms. Adeyemi chairs. Tom wants later hours. Grace wants the current hours, because the bus she takes stops early. They agree to a one-month try. **Speakers:** Ms. Adeyemi (F); Tom (M); Grace (F). **Length:** 2:17. **Tasks:** A: what are they deciding? B: match person → idea → reason; C: write *which* or *where*.
Read & Write	**Read:** the meeting agenda plus a 250-word proposal (about 400 words together). **Write:** a 6–8 sentence comment you would hand to the chair: what you support, one reason, and a question with *which* or *where*.
Exit ticket	*Which idea do you support, and where would you say it?* Four sentences with *which* or *where*, a reason, and one polite phrase.
Pronunciation	*which* is not *witch*. A short pause before *which* or *where* when the clause adds important information.
Common mix-up	*The room which we meet → The room where we meet. The proposal which the chair read it →* drop *it. The person which takes notes → who.*
Teacher tip	The question is library hours or a school conference time. No elections and no party names. The chair's job is to keep the order, not to win. Thank the learner who invites a quiet person to speak.

Lesson 13 (Week 14): A Short Talk

Part	Plan
Theme and life skill	Plan and rehearse a 2–3 minute talk: an introduction, two examples, and a conclusion. The topic is an accomplishment, a skill, or someone who helped. The learner chooses how personal to be.
Can-do goals	I can open a talk with one clear sentence. • I can give two examples. • I can close with a next step. • I can speak for about two minutes from notes.
Grammar Q&A focus	**I (frame, not a new tense):** *Introduction → Example 1 → Example 2 → Conclusion.* • Useful review sentences, one each: *I've been learning… / By the time I finished…, I had… / I wish I had…, so next time I will… / I'm going to…* • **R:** *will* and *going to* for the next step. • **Rule of thumb:** the introduction names the point. Each example has a detail. The conclusion repeats the point in new words and adds a next step.
Vocabulary (12)	★ outline • ★ notecard • ★ pause • ★ eye contact • ★ introduction • ★ example • ★ conclusion • ★ mentor • ★ applause • ★ community center • achievement • stopwatch
Talk Time	**Round 1, Outline Aloud:** partners read their four-part outline. The listener asks one question about an example. **Round 2, Timed Rehearsal:** groups of 3. A learner is the timekeeper with a stopwatch (about 2 minutes, up to 3). Listeners write one strength and one tip. Everyone rehearses. **15:** pairs, then 5 groups of 3. **7–8:** pairs, then 2–3 groups. **5 or fewer:** everyone rehearses for the whole group.
Listening	**Situation:** Imani, a former learner, gives a short talk at a practice night: what she has been learning, one hard moment, one person who helped, and her next step. Mr. Gordon asks one question. **Speakers:** Imani (F); Mr. Gordon (M). **Length:** 1:47. **Tasks:** A: what is her main point? B: label introduction, example, conclusion; C: write the order of four ideas.
Read & Write	**Read:** a printed copy of a 2-minute talk (about 320 words) with the four parts marked. **Write:** the learner's own outline and then the talk in 12–16 sentences. Finish at home. (Writing check 5.)
Exit ticket	*Write your introduction and your conclusion only.* Four sentences. You will say the examples in the rehearsal.
Pronunciation	A pause between the four parts. Slow down on the introduction and the conclusion. Eye contact means looking up from the card, not memorizing.
Common mix-up	A talk that starts with the example and never says the point. A conclusion that is a new story. The frame is there to stop both.
Teacher tip	"My class," "my job," or "a person who helped me practice" is always enough. Never ask about a journey to this country, family separation, or a hard personal event. Reading from cards is fine at graduation. Model a one-minute version of your own first. Applause is for finishing, not for the most dramatic story.

Week 15: Final Exam · Week 16: Graduation

See Section 7.

7. Midterm, Final, and Graduation

Same evening shape as Level 4. Level 5 changes: the listening is longer and is still played **2 times**, the writing is a **paragraph** at the midterm and a **short letter** at the final, and the speaking interview includes a **summary of about four sentences** and a **response to the partner**.

	Week 8: Midterm	Week 15: Final
Covers	Lessons 1–7: present perfect continuous; past perfect; *wish* and one third-conditional sentence; *unless / as long as / even though*; present and past passive; *said / told / asked*; tag questions	All lessons, with more items from 8–13: embedded *if / whether*; *must / might / can't*; *so / such… that*; gerund subjects; *I was wondering if*; *which / where*; the talk frame
Review stations (6:00–6:25)	Grammar sort (which time is earlier?), message relay, tag-question correction, a one-minute interview	Source check (*must / might / can't*), a four-minute meeting, letter outlines, talk rehearsal
Listening (6:25–6:45)	10 items from a practice interview and a clinic message. Main idea, details, one grammar word. The teacher plays the audio 2 times.	10 items from a website conversation, a claim call, and a short meeting. Same task types.
Grammar (7:00–7:12)	16 items: circle (*been working / worked*, *had / did*, *wish I had / wish I would*, *unless / if*, *was added / added*, *told me / said me*, the tag) and 4 fix-the-mistake items	16 items: circle (*if the office is / if is the office*, *must be / must*, *so… that / so… so*, *Waiting is / Waiting are*, *which / where / who*, statement order after *wondering if*) and 4 fix-the-mistake items
Writing (7:12–7:25)	A paragraph of 6–8 sentences: a project in order, or a mild regret and a next step	A short letter of 8–12 sentences: a claim, a request to an office, or a thank-you to a mentor
Speaking (about 4 minutes a pair)	Two baseline prompts, then a pair task: a practice interview or a message relay	The same baseline prompts, then a pair task: judge a page, or agree on a compromise
Score	The Level 4 1–3 rubric (communication, the target grammar, pronunciation and fluency). A **3 in communication** means about **four connected sentences**, a reason, and a response to the partner.	Same
Self-check	Can-do lines and one goal	Can-do lines and the completion note below

> **Exam night with 15 learners:** interviews start during the review stations and continue during the written parts. With 7–8 learners the interviews take about half as long.

Completion note (for the teacher's folder, not a gate the learner must pass to attend graduation): the learner came to at least 9 of the 13 lessons, took the final, scored 2 or higher on each part of the speaking rubric, and wrote a letter or paragraph of at least 8 sentences that a reader can understand on the first reading. Learners who do not meet the note still give their talk and receive a certificate. There is no Level 6 to place them into. The teacher can invite a learner to repeat Level 5.

Week 16: Graduation. No new content. Each learner gives the **2–3 minute talk** from Lesson 13. Reading from cards is fine. A shorter talk is fine. Certificates. An optional shared snack: ask about allergies, and do not require anyone to bring food. Hand out a "Keep practicing" sheet: the class website, how to find the

audio when it is published, the public library, and a local help line for work, housing, and consumer questions. The teacher checks those local numbers before the night. The sheet does not give legal, medical, or financial advice.

8. Decisions

These are the choices the lesson build should follow. They are not a claim that the owner has already approved them. Change them before the lessons are published if a row is wrong.

1. **English-only student pages.** No contrast-tip box. The common mix-up is a row in the mistakes table, in English. An optional glossary sits at the back of the book, with a blank *My language* column the learner fills in. The weekly New Words page has no *My language* column.
2. **One main new point a week.** *Should have* stays inside Lesson 3. *So / such… that* stays inside Lesson 10. Phrasal verbs in Lesson 10 are a review of three verbs, not a new lesson.
3. **Not advice.** Lesson 4 is not legal advice. Lesson 5 is not financial advice, and "credit" means a credit on a statement. Lesson 6 is not medical advice. Lesson 11 is not insurance advice. The teacher script says so in one sentence, and the student page does not.
4. **Audio, when it is recorded later.** About **2:05–2:40**, **2–3 speakers in a scene**, a fourth speaker only in a separate scene, **two class plays**, full forms *going to* and *want to*, and the same recognition tip for *gonna* and *wanna* as Level 4. **No background sound** in the first build. Do not start that recording from this document.
5. **Slides.** Build them from the lesson pages, not from this scope. Lesson 1 starts from the Level 4 Lesson 13 deck. Do not invent a slide line the lesson page does not have.
6. **Sensitive prompts.** No questions about how a learner came to this country, family separation, income, debt, real diagnoses, or real employers. Practice interviews, clinic messages, statements, and claims use invented facts.
7. **Names and numbers.** All invented. Prefer names and figures the later listening check can hear. Avoid a second meaning that depends on *gonna*, *wanna*, or a string of digits the checker has failed on before.
8. **Graduation.** Everyone who wants to speak can speak. The completion note in Section 7 is for the teacher's folder. It is not a rule that keeps someone out of the ceremony.

© 2026 the authors, CC BY-NC-SA 4.0